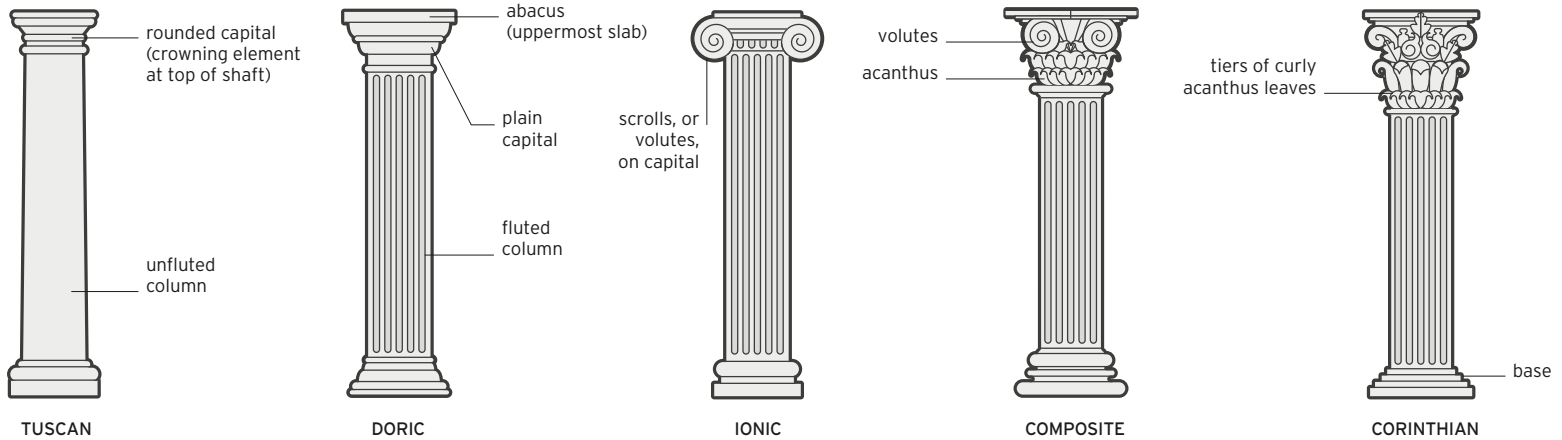


ORDER

Established by the ancient Greeks and Romans, the architectural orders are styles of Classical architecture characterized by their prescribed proportions and detailing. This is most evident in columns. Of the three main orders, the Doric column is short and heavy with plain, rounded capitals. The Ionic column is more

slender, and it is topped by a capital decorated with volutes. The Corinthian column is the most slender, and has an ornate capital decorated with two rows of acanthus leaves. Doric columns have 20 flutes and the other two, 24. To these, the Romans added the plainest order—Tuscan—and the most decorative order—Composite.



OCULUS A circular opening at the apex of a dome or in a wall.

OGEE An S-shaped curve. For example, an ogee arch is one in which the two sides curve upward at the top of the arch to meet in a point. *See also* arch.

ONION DOME A dome that has a larger diameter than the drum on which it sits so that it curves inward at the bottom. The height is greater than the width, and the dome tapers to a point at the top. *See also* dome.

ORDER *See* panel, above.

P

PAGODA A tiered tower with projecting eaves, common to the architecture of Southeast Asia.

PALLADIANISM An architectural style based on the designs and ideas of 16th-century Italian architect Andrea Palladio. Palladio was heavily influenced by the buildings of ancient Rome, and his architecture

was based on Classical proportions with plain, typically symmetrical exteriors, often with porticos and a cruciform plan. Palladio's *Four Books of Architecture*, first published in 1570, was highly influential. *See also* Classical, cruciform, portico.

PANOPTICON A prison with cells arranged in a circle so that they can all be seen from a central observation point.

PARAPET A low wall around the edge of a roof, terrace, or balcony.

PARTERRE A garden with beds divided in an ornamental pattern.

PAVILION A subsidiary building that stands separately or is attached to a main building.

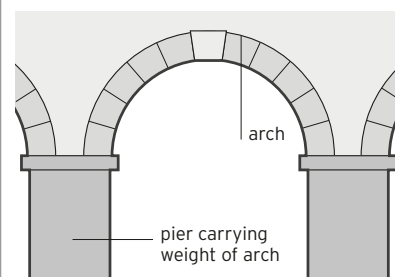
PEDIMENT In Classical architecture, the usually triangular gable that sits above the entablature, the whole of which is typically supported by columns. *See also* entablature, gable.

PENDENTIVE A structural device that facilitates the placing of a circular dome over a square room. Pendentives are the triangular segments of a sphere that follow

the curve of the dome and then taper downward to a point at the corners of the walls. *See also* squinch.

PERISTYLE In Classical architecture, a colonnaded walkway around an inner courtyard. It is similar to a medieval cloister. *See also* colonnade.

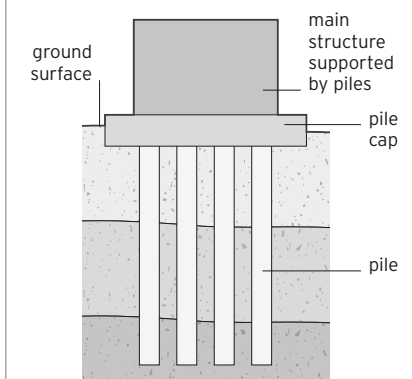
PIANO NOBILE The principal floor of a large house, with higher ceilings and grander rooms than on the other floors. The term came into use in Renaissance Italy, where the "noble floor" was usually on the first floor and expressed on the facade by enlarged windows.



PIER ▲ A vertical supporting element of a structure, such as an arch or bridge.

PILASTER A false column, rectangular in shape and projecting only slightly beyond the wall into which it is built. It is purely decorative.

PILE ▼ A large post of timber, steel, or poured concrete sunk deep into the ground to support a structure above.



PILLAR An isolated vertical structural element, of any cross-section, that typically has a load-bearing function.

PILOTI A support, such as a column, pillar, or stilt, that lifts a building off the ground—for example, in a structure built above water or a building with an open area beneath the lower floor.

PINNACLE A small spire frequently employed in Gothic architecture to ornament the corners of towers or the tops of buttresses.

PLINTH The base of a column.